

Task: Build Real-Time Chat App

Build a real-time chat application using:

- Next.js + TypeScript + Tailwind CSS
- Appwrite Free Plan
- Vercel Free Plan

Requirements:

- Email/password signup, login, logout
- Protected /chat page
- Display a list of registered users
- Allow a logged-in user to select another user and start a one-to-one conversation
- Messages must be associated with the correct sender and recipient
- Opening a conversation should display only the messages belonging to those two users
- Users should be able to switch between different conversations
- Previously exchanged messages should load when a conversation is opened
- The selected conversation should be clearly identifiable in the UI
- Real-time messaging using Appwrite Realtime
- Store messages in Appwrite Database
- Show sender name and timestamp
- Auto-scroll to newest message
- Prevent empty messages
- Responsive mobile/desktop UI
- Use environment variables and do not expose secret API keys
- Deploy the frontend on Vercel
- Configure the Vercel domain in Appwrite
- Test real-time messaging using two different logged-in users

Bonus (optional, not required):

- Unread message indicator/count for conversations not currently open, cleared when opened
- UI feedback while a message is being sent, and graceful handling of failed delivery

Deliverables:

- Complete source code
- .env.example
- README with Appwrite setup instructions
- GitHub repository
- Working Vercel deployment URL